

We're up to פרשת ויקרא, having just finished חזק חזק ונתחזק. This דבר תורה is dedicated לעילוי פרשת ויקרא, whose יארצייט falls on Monday of this week, during פרשת ויקרא. What fascinates me about ספר ויקרא are all of the כוונות and the הנהגות of the בית המקדש. Many view it as esoteric, yet in the Hirsch חומש ויקרא, ספר ויקרא is the only one of the five חומשים that spans two volumes. Clearly, there is so much to learn from the קרבנות, and we must delve into what they teach us. However, before the קרבנות, we start with the פסוק: ויקרא אל משה. Everybody knows about the little א in ויקרא, that before the קרבנות, משה רבינו in his modesty did not want to appear superior to all of the other נביאים. He wanted to write what got, which was ויקרא. Hashem said that he should write ויקרא, and the compromise was the little א in ויקרא.

Lutzker Rav, R' Zalman Sorotzkin, asks, why did משה רבינו wait for Hashem to call him? Nowhere else do we see this wording. Typically, the תורה states, ויקרא אל משה, לאמר. Why here does it say, ויקרא אל משה - that Hashem called to משה?

The תורה brings down a מדרש תנחומא. משה רבינו assumed that once he built the משכן, his job was done, his שליחות was finished. As we have discussed previously, the משכן serves as a continuation of מעמד השראת השכינה through הקדוש ברוך הוא to maintain a connection with כלל ישראל. Therefore Hashem called him and he said: ויש לי מלאכה גדולה מכל מה שעשית - I have a bigger job for you, more important than anything else that you have done. I want you to teach בני ישראל the הלכות of טומאה, to warn them that you have to be in a proper state, because their job is to be מקריב קרבנות before Me. This language of the תנחומא raises a question: מלאכה גדולה מכל מה שעשית - bigger than anything else you have done? קריעת ים סוף is pretty impressive, קריעת ים סוף?

The תורה answers that the תנחומא is teaching us that בני ישראל needed to be taught that in order to go up to the ה' ה' ה', going up is important, but to be במקום קדשו, how do we get there and stay at that level? That is through the medium of טומאה וטהרה, we can achieve דבקות to Hashem with the קרבנות. How is that greater than קריעת ים סוף? The answer is in the famous vort קשה זיווג between a חתן and a כלה, between a husband and a wife, is even greater than קריעת ים סוף. Therefore, the Lutzker Rav says, the זיווג of ישראל and כלל ישראל is even קשה מקריעת ים סוף.

It happens to be that this past Monday, כ"ז אדר, was the first יארצייט of my מרדכי בת מרדכי, תמר רייזל בת מרדכי, and in whose זכות we are learning, and in זכות of my father, אהרן בן יששכר, and my אברהם, תיירה בריד, אברהם. Decades ago, my mother was honored at the Young Israel of Forest Hills, and it happened to be during this very week. I was looking for a דבר תורה to find to say in her honor, and I used this particular דבר תורה at that time, and pointed out that her job in life was constantly to be מעלה בקדש to go up and up, עליית נשמה, and she was successful in המקום קדשו. The זכות of this learning should be an זכות for her, and we should all be זוכה to follow in her footsteps.

